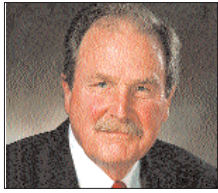




120 PGR 3
(Xbox 360)



127 Compression
Is Key



140 Of Billionaires
And Beds

Digital Leisure

Technology Beyond Work

Lead Feature

Timepass Tips

Got time to kill? Got an unlimited-usage broadband connection? Welcome to Time and Bandwidth Wasting 101...

Agent 001

Back in 1999, I was one of the first few Indians to have an unlimited, always-on connection. It was only 64 Kbps, nothing to brag about, but at least I didn't have to worry about phone bills! For a thousand rupees a month, I'd managed to break free of the shackles of copper wire, local call charges, and my parents moaning about how no-one could ever get through to our phone! What's more, I actually used to get 64 Kbps (8 KBps) download speeds,

which was a *lot* faster than the 16 Kbps (2 KBps) I'd become accustomed to on dial-up.

Because it was 1999, broadband ISPs were still learning, I guess, and I soon discovered that my ISP had limited the download speeds, but had forgotten to do the same with uploads. The result? A mere 8 KBps for downloads, and a whopping 400 KBps upload speed!

I'm somewhat of an IRC (Internet Relay Chat) addict, so I was promptly on my favourite network, showing off to my friends. There were even people in Amer-

ica who didn't have 400 KBps upload bandwidth back then!

I found myself obsessing about my upload capabilities, not wanting to let it go to waste! I also knew that sooner or later some engineer at my ISP would awake from his slumber and prick my heavenly bubble. As it turned out, this scenario lasted about six months, and I uploaded more in those six months than I've downloaded since 1999. I also set up my site on my own computer, an FTP server, IRC bots to transfer and share loads of files, and absolutely anything that would use my upload capability.

Illustration: Sri Krishna Patkar

